

Project Folder Creator Quick Start

0.4.1 build 20 · 3 September 2026

Version 0.4.1 build 20. The full document is the `Project Folder Creator User Guide` — this is the one page that gets a project made.

Development build. Not released, and not through acceptance on real facility storage. Create a project on storage you can throw away before you create one that matters.

If somebody handed you a profile

A profile is the whole set-up under a name — the template, the storage, and which branches of the template each storage receives. Import it once and the job is two fields.

1. **Profile** → **Import Profile...** and choose the `.pfcprofile` folder. Once, on this Mac.
2. Type the **project number** (`2026-123`) and the **project name**.
3. Read the plan on the right: every final path, in full.
4. **Create Project**, and confirm.
5. Check each destination says **verified**.

That is the whole daily loop. A profile whose archive drive is not plugged in still loads and still says so; but every destination in the plan has to be mounted before the run, so mount it — or remove that card for today and add it back when the drive is there.

If you are setting it up yourself

1. **Drop the main template** onto *Main template*. It is read, never modified.
 2. **Project number and name** — `YYYY-NNN` , and a name. Neither may contain `{ } [ ]` .
 3. **Add Edit, Archive, Cloud or Custom Storage...** for each destination, then on each card set:
 - *Projects in* — the relative folder that holds projects, such as `Projects` , or blank if the folder you chose is already it;
 - *Arrangement* — projects directly in that folder, or inside a `YYYY` folder.
- The grey path under the card is where the project will really go. Read it.
4. **Edit Copy Rules** on each destination and tick what that storage receives. Edit might take the whole template; Archive might take only `1n {project}` and everything under it. Every destination needs at least one item.
 5. **The pencil** beside any template name that should change — `1n 2026-xxx` becomes `1n {project}` . A name in orange is one the app thinks is still a placeholder.
 6. **Create Project**, confirm, and check every destination.
 7. **Save as Profile...** once it is right, and **Export Profile...** to hand it to somebody else.

Before you press Create

- The plan panel is the authority, not the cards. Expand **Show the folders this creates**.
- Green preview text is the name that will be written. Orange is a warning to read.
- The button stays disabled while the plan is invalid; the panel says why.
- An existing project number is refused. So is a storage whose volume is not really mounted — a folder under `/Volumes` looks identical whether the drive is there or not.

Afterwards

A receipt — JSON and text — is written to this Mac on every run, at `~/Library/Application Support/Project Folder Creator/Receipts`. There is nothing to switch on. **Reveal Receipt** opens it. Set a receipts folder in section 4 if a copy should also land somewhere the facility can see.

- **Retry Incomplete** replans only what failed and reverifies what already committed.
- **New Project** clears the number and name and keeps everything else.
- A failed destination may leave a hidden staging folder. It is listed with a Reveal button, and the app never deletes one — it may be the only record of what the failed copy achieved.

When something is wrong

What you see	What it means
Create is disabled	Read the plan panel; it names the refusal. A receipts folder is not required
<i>not there yet</i> under a card	The project directory does not exist. Only the year folder is created for you
A storage is not mounted	Mount it. The refusal prints the mount table, because a volume's name and the folder it mounts at can differ
A name is orange	It still looks like a template placeholder. Use the pencil
Unknown token	Fix the brackets, or confirm the name really is a literal folder
The project list is incomplete	A destination could not be read. Do not assume a number is free